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CHARLESTON—A gruelling five-game series in three days awaits the injury and illness-plagued Indianapolis Indians here on their arrival after a 1,369-mile air journey from Denver.

After a single game tonight, double-headers are booked tomorrow night and Sunday

afternoon in one of the more exhausting arrangements of a cruel and awkward American Association schedule. Manager Andy Cohen has the pitchers for the job here—at least in number

—but he lacks replacements in other positions should they become necessary.

The shortage of manpower was relieved to some extent with the arrival here of Sam Mele, who has been out of action more than a week with a pinched nerve in his back. But, for the time being, the veteran outfielder may be used only as a pinch-hitter.

"I have been working out at Indianapolis," said Mele, "and haven't had any bad effects. They said it was all right for me to play, but I have to wear a brace, something like a corset."

Mele denied that this was a recurrence of an old back injury.

"This is the first time I've ever had anything like this," he said. "The first few days it felt like a knife in my back. I could hardly move and had to roll out of bed like a snake. But after several heat treatments the back began to feel better."

The ailment came on Mele suddenly and may have developed from the diving catch that Sam made on a fly ball in the last home game at Indianapolis. But doctors will not say that was the cause.

Before Mele was sidelined by the injury, he had played all of seven consecutive games, his longest stretch of activity in several years.

The loss of Mele was another fellow's gain, however, as it gave Dick DiTusa an opportunity to break into the lineup and prove himself with the Indians, or play himself off the team. The youngster responded almost immediately and figures to stick around, perhaps permanently.

Today the Indians could reflect on some encouraging developments after last night's 8-7, 12-inning victory over Denver.

Foremost was the fact that already this season they have won a series at Denver—something they never came close to doing last year even with a pennant-winning ball club.

For this feat they drew praise from Denver Manager Ralph Houk, who conceded through the bitter aftermath of defeat: "They've got a pretty good triple-A ball club. They could use some more pitching but so could I."

Happiest of all the developments was the hitting of DiTusa, the rookie from Colorado Springs. Dick, who had three hits in the series opener and one in the second game, delivered a three-run double and a solo homer last night. These feats turned a 4-2 deficit into a 7-4 lead after DiTusa scored on a sacrifice fly.

Unfortunately these heroics weren't quite enough as the Bears came up with some clutch hitting of their own with two out in the eighth to send the game into extra innings with a three-run rally.

That gave Ron Jackson another chance to show his wares.

Big Ron, who had already hit a valuable two-run homer (No. 4) in the first inning, and a double in the 10th, broke up the ball game in the 12th.

With Vince Garcia on second base following a walk and Jim Delsing's sacrifice, Jackson shot a low line double to dead center to drive in the winning run.

Manager Cohen, still seeking the answers on his pitching staff, could logically reach this conclusion: His hurlers don't mind a little trouble. At least they seemed to thrive on it last night.

HIGH SCHOOL TENNIS

CATHEDRAL 6, NORTH CENTRAL 1
HOWE 5, BROAD RIFLE 2
TECH 5, Anderson 2

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